

Summarization Instruction Pool

50 hand-crafted prompts · 10 dimensions × 5 instructions each

GenSens Prompt Sensitivity Benchmark — gensens/data/summ_instruction_pool.jsonl

Dimension Overview

#	Dimension	What It Varies	Sim Mean
1	Direct Command	Plain imperative. Varies verb and focus — no framing, role, or format co	0.815
2	Question Form	Question the reader answers about the article. Varies which aspect is as	0.721
3	Role Based	Assigns a professional persona before asking for the summary.	0.706
4	Constraint Based	Imposes a hard output constraint — varies constraint TYPE (word count, s	0.847
5	Analytical Framing	Asks for structured analysis (5W, cause-effect, claim-evidence, conflict	0.678
6	Output Format	Specifies a non-prose output structure (bullets, tweet, headline+body, t	0.774
7	Audience Perspective	Tailors the summary for a specific reader type.	0.767
8	Emphasis Focus	Directs attention to a specific content aspect (people, stats, timeline,	0.764
9	Tone Register	Specifies the voice or register of the output (formal, casual, dry, vivi	0.814
10	Completeness Framing	Frames what to include, exclude, or prioritise (exhaustive, minimal, flo	0.831

Dimension 1 — Direct Command

Plain imperative. Varies verb and focus — no framing, role, or format constraint.

1. Summarize the following news article in 3-4 sentences, capturing the main events and key details.

SBERT sim to canonical: 1.000 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. Extract the most newsworthy information from the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.734 · Complexity: simple (level 1)

3. Recap the key developments from the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.740 · Complexity: simple (level 1)

4. Condense the following news article into its most essential points.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.812 · Complexity: simple (level 1)

5. Restate the main points of the following news article in your own words.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.789 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 2 — Question Form

Question the reader answers about the article. Varies which aspect is asked about.

1. What events or decisions led to the situation described in the following news article?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.711 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. What is the main story being reported in the following news article?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.769 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. What happened according to the following news article?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.679 · Complexity: simple (level 1)

4. What is the most significant or surprising development described in the following news article?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.689 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. What does the following news article want the reader to understand?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.758 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 3 — Role Based

Assigns a professional persona before asking for the summary.

1. As a news editor, write a short summary of the following article for the front page.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.767 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. You are a student writing a research report. Summarize the following news article to use as a reference source.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.799 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Acting as a research assistant, extract the key findings from the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.711 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

4. Imagine you are a news anchor introducing this story on television. Write a brief introduction based on the following article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.653 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. As a librarian creating a catalog entry, write a short description of what the following news article covers.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.599 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 4 — Constraint Based

Imposes a hard output constraint — varies constraint TYPE (word count, structure, vocabulary, format).

1. In no more than 50 words, summarize the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.881 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. Give a three-part summary of the following news article: context, main event, and outcome.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.881 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Write a one-sentence summary of the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.877 · Complexity: simple (level 1)

4. Summarize the following news article using only plain, everyday words — avoid jargon or technical language.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.804 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. Summarize the following news article as a series of short, telegraphic phrases — no full sentences needed.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.794 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 5 — Analytical Framing

Asks for structured analysis (5W, cause-effect, claim-evidence, conflict).

1. For the following news article, identify the who, what, when, where, and why.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.772 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. What is the central claim made in the following news article and what evidence is provided to support it?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.576 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Analyse the following news article and explain the cause-and-effect relationship it describes.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.664 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

4. Break down the following news article into its main claim and the key facts that support it.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.760 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. What is the underlying conflict or issue described in the following news article, and how is it being addressed?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.618 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 6 — Output Format

Specifies a non-prose output structure (bullets, tweet, headline+body, template).

1. Write 3 bullet points summarizing the most important information from the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.805 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. Create a short headline and a two-sentence summary for the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.728 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Summarize the following news article as if writing a tweet — keep it clear, punchy, and under 280 characters.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.828 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

4. Write a numbered list of the 3 most important takeaways from the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.736 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. Summarize the following news article using this format: Main Event | Key People | Outcome.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.771 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 7 — Audience Perspective

Tailors the summary for a specific reader type.

1. Explain the following news article to someone who has no background knowledge on the topic.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.683 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. Summarize the following news article for a busy executive who only has 30 seconds to read it.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.797 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Write a summary of the following news article that would be easy for a high school student to understand.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.846 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

4. Summarize the following news article for a non-native English speaker — use simple, clear language.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.852 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. Summarize the following news article in a way that a domain expert would find concise and professionally useful.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.657 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 8 — Emphasis Focus

Directs attention to a specific content aspect (people, stats, timeline, impact).

1. Summarize the following news article focusing specifically on the people involved and their roles.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.823 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. What problem is described in the following news article, and what solutions or responses are mentioned?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.583 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Summarize the following news article paying special attention to any numbers, statistics, or specific facts mentioned.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.851 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

4. Describe the timeline of events in the following news article in chronological order.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.749 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. Summarize the following news article by highlighting its potential impact or consequences.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.814 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 9 — Tone Register

Specifies the voice or register of the output (formal, casual, dry, vivid).

1. Write a formal, objective summary of the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.864 · Complexity: simple (level 1)

2. Give a casual, conversational overview of what the following news article is about.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.801 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Write a dry, factual account of the events described in the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.815 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

4. Write a vivid, journalistic account of the events described in the following news article.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.791 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. Write an engaging, reader-friendly summary of the following news article that makes someone want to read the full story.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.797 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

Dimension 10 — Completeness Framing

Frames what to include, exclude, or prioritise (exhaustive, minimal, flow, takeaway).

1. Summarize the following news article capturing both the factual content and why the story matters.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.844 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

2. What is the single most important takeaway from the following news article?

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.745 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

3. Summarize the following news article from start to finish, preserving the logical flow of events.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.836 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

4. Give a minimal summary of the following news article — just the essential facts, nothing extra.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.856 · Complexity: moderate (level 2)

5. Summarize the following news article so that someone who did not read it would have a complete understanding of the story.

SBERT sim to canonical: 0.875 · Complexity: detailed (level 3)

Canonical instruction (similarity anchor): *Summarize the following news article in 3-4 sentences, capturing the main events and key details.*